

Person 1: Introduction + Key Ideas

INTRODUCTION:

Letters form words, words form sentences, and sentences form what we call **paragraphs**.

What is a Paragraph?

A paragraph is a text compounded by several sentences written consecutively, managing to address the same topic. In fact, what you are reading right now could be said to be a paragraph and it is the best example!

Remember that these texts always start with a capital letter and that if there is a period followed, it will again be a capital letter. A paragraph ends just when the idea has already been fully developed or simply because the topic has already finished.

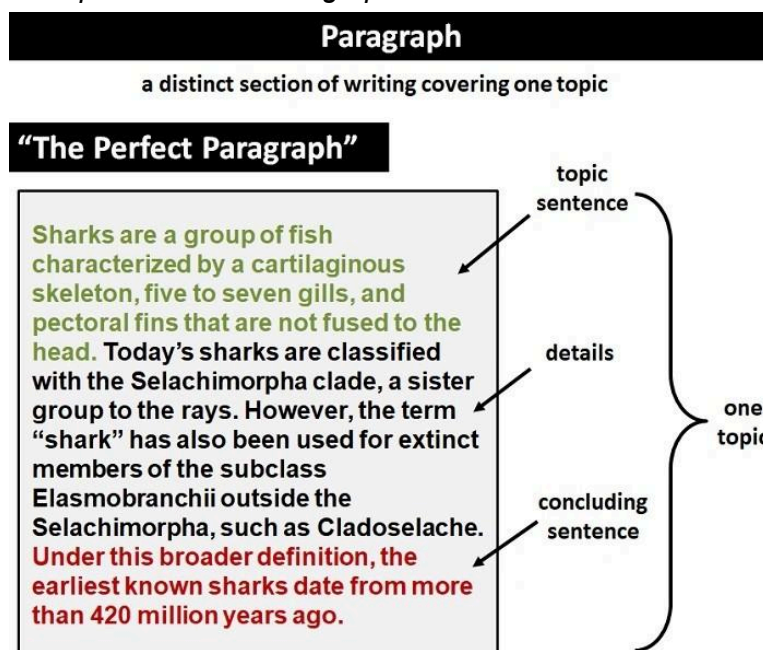
Other Definition of Paragraph:

A Paragraph is a distinct section of a writing covering one topic. A paragraph will usually contain **more than one sentence**. A typical paragraph consists of 5-7 sentences, but this is not the rule for the length of a paragraph. The length depends on the topic and the content.

The Perfect Paragraph:

It will start with a topic sentence. It will have detailed sentences in the middle and end with a concluding sentence. It only covers one topic from start to finish.

Example of Perfect Paragraph



source: <https://www.grammar-monster.com/glossary/paragraph.htm>

For you to be able to create a good paragraph, organization is important.

What is Organization in Writing?

Organization is the backbone of any well-written piece. It provides structure, coherence, and a logical flow that guides readers from the beginning to the end. So in order for readers to understand your paragraph, you need to make sure that your sentences are organized.

For you to fully understand the process of creating a paragraph, we will discuss another important part, that is identifying the main idea and its supporting details.

What is Main Idea?

The “main idea” is the topic or most important point of a writing, picture, or conversation.

Main Idea = What it’s about

What are Supporting Details?

The “supporting details” of the text, picture, or conversation are the facts that tell you about the main idea.

Supporting Details = Information about the Topic

Sample text (MAIN IDEA & SUPPORTING DETAILS)

The zoo is the best place to go for a field trip. The zoo has many different animals that you can observe in their natural habitats. You can learn a lot about the animals at the zoo. There is also food at the zoo in case you get hungry while you are there. The zoo is big so there is plenty of room to move and play. We should go to the zoo on field trips more often.

From the sample above, the main idea is that the zoo is the best place to go for a field trip and the sentences after the main idea are the evidence or reasons that help support the main idea.

IT'S YOUR TURN!

MAIN IDEA:

SUPPORTING DETAILS:

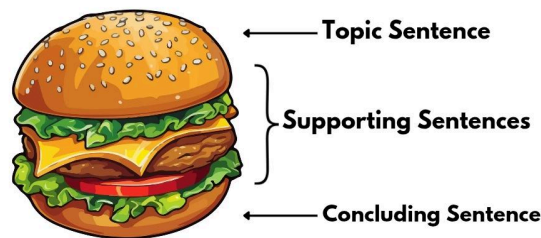
- 1.
 - 2.
 - 3.
-

Person 2: Parts of a Paragraph + Organizing Ideas

The Three Parts of a Paragraph: Topic Sentences, Support Sentences, & Conclusions

A paragraph has three main parts: the topic sentence, supporting sentences, and the concluding sentence. The **topic sentence** introduces the main idea of the paragraph. The **supporting sentences** develop the idea by giving details, reasons, or examples. The **concluding sentence** ends the paragraph by summarizing the idea or giving a final thought.

To make this easier to understand, think of a paragraph like a burger: the **topic sentence** is the top bun, the **supporting sentences** are the filling, and the **concluding sentence** is the bottom bun. Together, these parts create a complete and well-organized paragraph.



1. Topic Sentence

The topic sentence is usually the first sentence in a paragraph. It introduces the main idea, and every other sentence in the paragraph must support it. A good paragraph focuses on just one main idea, which is clearly stated in the topic sentence.

- **Topic:** The main subject matter or idea covered in the paragraph.
- **Controlling idea:** This idea focuses the topic by providing direction to the composition.

Example: Reading daily improves language skills.

Topic Sentence: Reading daily

Controlling Idea: improves language skills.

2. Supporting Sentences

Supporting sentences are sentences that come after the topic sentence and make up the body of a paragraph. They provide details that develop and support the main idea of the paragraph.

The following are common sources of supporting details:

- **Statistics, polls, percentages**

Ex: Recent studies that compare student's test scores show that children who are exposed to structured learning activities outside the home environment are better able to adapt to formalized instruction than children who remain at home.

- **Facts, details, reasons, examples**

Ex: Washington, D.C., has some of the most interesting landmarks and tourist spots in the country. There are many monuments to visit, such as the Lincoln Memorial, the Jefferson Memorial, and the Washington Monument, which is the tallest building in Washington.

- **Personal experience, stories, anecdotes, examples from your life**

Ex: My favorite dish is pasta with fresh vegetables. The pasta is cooked just right, and the vegetables include broccoli, onions, tomatoes, and corn. My second favorite dish is spicy chicken and brown rice soup. The chicken is a little hot for some people's taste buds, but many people really like the fact that you get brown rice instead of the usual bland white rice.

3. Closing Sentences

The concluding sentence is the last sentence in a paragraph. It signals that the paragraph is ending.

A concluding sentence:

- restates the main idea using different words
- summarizes the paragraph without repeating the exact same words
- gives the reader something to think about.

Example:

Topic Sentence: Good time management helps students become more productive.

Concluding Sentence: As a result, managing time properly can help students achieve better academic success and reduce stress.

What Is Organizing Ideas?

- Organizing ideas is arranging information in a clear and logical order so the reader can easily understand the message. A well-organized paragraph focuses on one main idea and supports it with clear details, examples, or explanations.

There are different ways to organize paragraphs depending on the purpose of writing. The most common patterns are:

1. Classification

- Classification is a way of organizing ideas by grouping similar things into categories. Each group shares common features, making complex information easier to understand.

2. Chronological Sequence

- Chronological sequence organizes ideas based on time order. Events are arranged from first to last, showing how something happens step by step.

3. Evidence and Illustration

- Evidence and illustration organize ideas by using facts, examples, or details to support a main idea. This helps make explanations clearer and more convincing.

4. Comparison and Contrast

- Comparison and contrast organizes ideas by showing how two or more things are alike or different. This helps readers understand relationships between ideas.

5. Cause and Effect

- Cause and effect organizes ideas by explaining why something happens (cause) and what happens as a result (effect). It shows the relationship between actions and results.

Person 3: Types of Paragraphs + Writing Process

TYPES OF PARAGRAPH

Paragraph - A paragraph is a short group of structured sentences with a single theme, cohesiveness, and flow.

Descriptive Paragraph

- A descriptive paragraph is a piece of writing in which the writer enlightens the reader with details on a specific topic. Writers often draw inspiration from personal experiences. The author employs vivid imagery to entice the reader's senses. It makes it easier for the reader to envision themselves existing in the environment that the author depicts. In short, descriptive paragraphs do precisely what their name implies.

Example:

- *"The lights grow brighter as the earth lurches away from the sun, and now the orchestra is playing yellow cocktail music, and the opera of voices pitches a key higher. Laughter is easier minute by minute, spilled with prodigality, tipped out at a cheerful word. The groups change more swiftly, swell with new arrivals, dissolve and form in the same breath; already there are wanderers, confident girls who weave here and there among the stouter and more stable, become from a sharp, joyous moment the center of a group, and then, excited with triumph, glide on through the sea-change of faces and voices and color under the constantly changing light." (F. Scott Fitzgerald)*

Expository Paragraph

- This type of paragraph provides an explanation and guidance. It may also explain how to do something and lead the reader through each step. This kind of paragraph needs a lot of research by the writer. But they may also rely on their own experience and knowledge.

Example:

- *"All toilet flush tanks work about the same. When the toilet is flushed, the trip handle lifts the tank ball, opening the outlet and letting water flow into the bowl. When the tank is nearly empty, the ball falls back in place over the outlet. The float falls with the water level, opening the water-supply inlet valve just as the outlet is being closed, and the tank is refilled through the filler tube. Water also flows through the bowl refill tube into the overflow pipe to replenish trap-sealing water. As the water level in the tank nears the top of the overflow pipe, the float closes the inlet valve, completing the cycle."*

Narrative Paragraph

- A narrative paragraph contributes to the narrative and ensures that the plot continues to progress. Paragraphs that tell a story will have action, incidents, and intriguing phrases to describe them. These paragraphs serve to maintain the reader's interest in the narrative. A narrative paragraph provides the reader with more background information, such as the events that led to or triggered the story's current events.

Example:

- *"It's been almost ten years since I first ran for political office. I was thirty-five at the time, four years out of law school, recently married, and generally impatient with life. A seat in the Illinois legislature had opened up, and several friends suggested that I run, thinking that my work as a civil rights lawyer, and contacts from my days as a community organizer, would make me a viable candidate. After discussing it with my wife, I entered the race and proceeded to do what every first-time candidate does: I talked to anyone who would listen. I went to block club meetings and church socials, beauty shops and barbershops. If two guys were standing on a corner, I would cross the street to hand them campaign literature. And everywhere I went, I'd get some version of the same two questions." (Barack Obama)*

Persuasive Paragraph

- If you want to attract the reader's attention or make them comprehend and embrace your perspective, use a persuasive paragraph. Building an argument typically involves using persuasive paragraphs. These are rhetorical passages that use factual details to support the discussion and make it more credible. Confidence in a writer's opinion is necessary for readers to believe what they are reading. The author intends to sway the audience's perspectives.

Example:

- *"If you choose to use your position and influence to raise your voice on behalf of those who have no voice; if you choose to point not only to the powerful, but also to the weak; If you keep the power of self-reflection in the lives of those who do not have your own benefits, then not only will your proud families celebrate your existence, but the billions and millions of people you have helped change their reality. We do not need magic to*

change the world with all the power we need within us: we have the power to think better. “ (Anon Writer)

WRITING PROCESS

Step 1: Prewriting (Brainstorming)

- The process of thinking about your topic and organizing your thoughts before writing them down. Find your ideas; build on them; plan and structure.

Step 2: Drafting

- The process of putting your ideas down on paper without worrying about word count, structure, or grammar.

Step 3: Revising

- The process of refining, adding to or taking away (word count), and reorganizing your writing to make it stronger. Share your writing with peers, teachers, and family members for input at this stage.

Step 4: Editing

- The process of fixing any grammatical and spelling errors in your writing. Check word count. Share your writing with peers, teachers, and family members again for corrections.

Step 5: Publish

- The process of preparing and sharing your finished copy of your essay with those it was targeted for.

Person 4: Activities + Assessment

ACTIVITIES

Activity 1: Identify the Topic Sentence

Instructions: Read the paragraph below carefully. Identify which sentence acts as the Topic Sentence (the Top Bun containing the Topic + Controlling Idea).

[1] You need to pack fresh water, high-energy snacks, a sturdy map, and a basic first-aid kit. [2] Preparing a reliable survival pack is essential before heading out on any wilderness hiking trip. [3] A knife or multi-tool can also help you handle unexpected mechanical issues or clear small branches on the trail. [4] Finally, matches stored in a waterproof container ensure you can build a fire if the temperature drops at night.

Your Answer: _____

Activity 2: Arrange The Sentence Into Proper Paragraph

Instructions: The following sentences are scrambled. Drag and drop (or reorder) them by number so they form a logically organized paragraph with a clear Topic Sentence -Supporting Details-Concluding Sentence.

[1] For instance, the fast-paced gameplay and precise button inputs required in competitive matches help sharpen a player's spatial awareness.

[2] In conclusion, video games are more than just casual entertainment; they are powerful tools for brain development.

[3] Research shows that playing action-heavy video games can significantly improve a person's cognitive skills and reaction times.

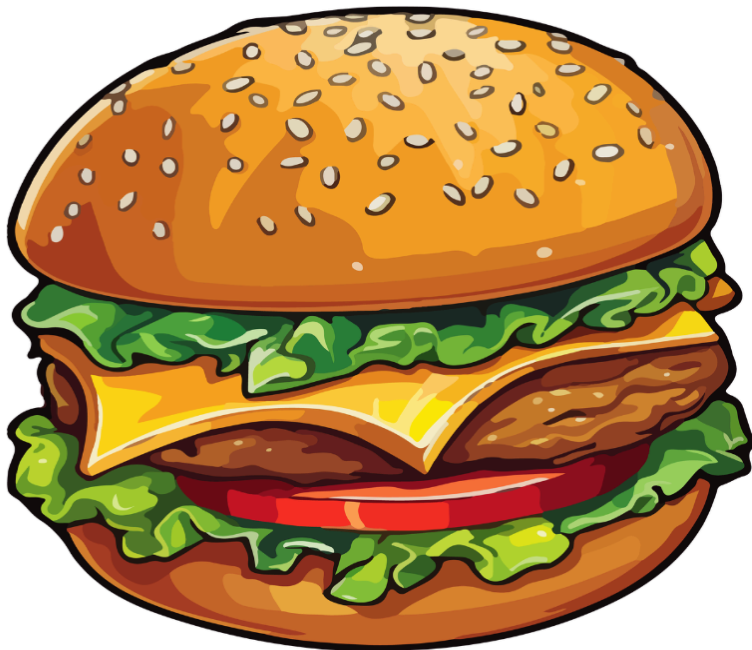
[4] Furthermore, navigating complex strategic puzzles in role-playing games exercises the brain's problem-solving centers.

Correct paragraph order: ____

Activity 3

Complete the paragraph Graphic Organizer

Instructions: Fill in the missing structural components of the graphic organizer based on the "Burger Metaphor" elements taught.



TOP BUN (TOPIC SENTENCE)

→ STATE YOUR TOPIC

→ Include a: _____

BURGER FILLINGS (SUPPORTING SENTENCES)

→ Detail 1: Concrete Facts/

Examples

→ Detail 2: _____

→ Detail 3: Personal Anecdote/

Illustration.

BOTTOM BUN (CONCLUDING SENTENCE)

→ Summarize your thoughts and

→ _____

Assessment

For Person 1.

Multiple choice

1. Is a text compounded by several sentences written consecutively, managing to address the same topic.

- a. Essay
- b. Paragraph
- c. Statement
- d. Article

2. How many sentences does a paragraph MUST contain?

- a. 1 only
- b. None
- c. More than 1
- d. It depends on the context

3. The perfect paragraph always starts with?

- a. Topic Sentence
- b. Details
- c. Title
- d. Concluding Sentence

4. What is described as the “Backbone” of effective writing

- a. Perfect Grammar
- b. Vocabulary Choices
- c. Organization
- d. Paragraph Length

5. These are the information or facts that tell you about the main idea.

- a. Conclusion
- b. Article details
- c. Abbreviated details
- d. Supporting details

Answer Key:

B
C
A
C
D

For Person 2

Paragraph Organization

Instruction: The sentences below are completely scrambled. Using the BURGER METAPHOR, identify the structural components and rearrange the number into a logical paragraph layout.

Fragmented Sentence:

- (1) For instance, a 2022 study published in the *Journal of Education* revealed that schools utilizing interactive digital modules saw a 15% increase in student retention rates.
- (2) In conclusion, incorporating multimedia tools into modern lessons is a highly effective strategy for boosting student engagement.
- (3) Classrooms that integrate dynamic multimedia elements create a significantly more stimulating learning environment for students.
- (4) On top of that, digital resources allow teachers to instantly adapt visual materials to fit different learning speeds and student needs.

Answer Key

3, 1, 4, 2

For Person 3

Short writing

Instruction: Select one rhetorical style for writing a paragraph. Draft a 5 to 7 sentence paragraph and put the 5 step writing process into practice.

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